

54-88-41
A

DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAPE BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

Species: Eastern Meadowlark
(Vernacular name)

Sturnella magna
(Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): 6 June 1988 Time Bird Seen: 1830 ^{on + off from} to 2000

Locality: Tamarack Check Station, Tamarack Ranch
1.5 miles S Crook, CO
Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: Nikon 9x30 binoculars

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: None

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: ♂? Plumage: _____

Light conditions: Good. Clear, calm

Distance from bird, and how measured: usually ~ 200m

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

Several ⁽³⁾ times during the evening the bird flew in to the grassland/shrubland N of the check station & began singing. Each time the bird sang for 3-5 minutes & was then driven off by a resident Western Meadowlark. Although I was camped there for several days on either side of this date, the bird was not seen at any other time.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

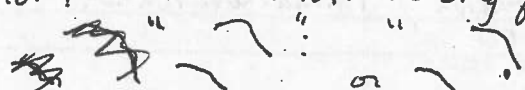
Sagebrush grassland/shrubland

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

None

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

Too far away to critically examine the plumage - identification by voice alone. Typical meadowlark plumage.

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.: Gave 2 variants of a clear whistled song typical of this species, not the melodic flute-like song of Western Meadowlark.
4-5 syllables 

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

Without seeing the plumage in detail there is the possibility that it was a Western Meadowlark that had learned an Eastern song, or a hybrid. But the 2 song variants were identical to the 2 variants given to the one I found on the Hudson BBS on 12 June 1988, which was examined in detail. (see other rare bird form)

Prior experience with this and similar species:

Much experience with both species, including in eastern New Mexico where they are sympatric.

This report was written from notes made during ___ after ☒ observation; from memory ☒.

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Signature: Bill Howe

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
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Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205